

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 991

By Clemmons

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Judge John P. Brown of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Judge John P. Brown of Nashville; and

WHEREAS, a Nashville native, John Brown was born on January 6, 1942, to J.P. and Hazel Spillers Brown; he was a 1960 graduate of Hillsboro High School, where he met his first wife, Lolann Wamser Brown; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from the University of Tennessee at Memphis Pharmacy School in 1964, Mr. Brown joined the family business, J.P. Brown Drugstores, where he had worked the counter and soda fountain as a young man; he opened his store on Hillsboro Road and helped build J.P. Brown Drugstores into Nashville's largest independent pharmacy; and

WHEREAS, John Brown soon decided to pivot, attending the Nashville YMCA Law School and obtaining his Juris Doctorate in 1969; he practiced law for many years, handling a variety of civil and criminal matters at his law office in Green Hills while being active in local politics; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brown was elected to serve as judge of Davidson County General Sessions Court Division V in 1982 and served in that position until his retirement from the bench in 2006; and

WHEREAS, Judge John Brown was a compassionate and wise jurist, beloved by the courthouse crowd for his southern drawl and folksy humor; during his tenure, he played an integral role in bringing Courts into the computer age, serving on the Justice Information System Committee for many years; and

WHEREAS, after retiring from the bench, John Brown and his wife, Anne, spent a year in the Republic of Georgia after he was selected for the competitive American Bar Association CEELI Program, through which he helped train judges on the court system of a new democracy governed by the rule of law; and

WHEREAS, during his retirement, he continued to serve as Senior Judge and work as a pharmacist, and he even tried his hand at selling cars with Lexus of Nashville; and

WHEREAS, he further served his community as a volunteer with Operation Stand Down, a program that helps veterans with legal issues, housing, and jobs; he began his work with the program when it was in its infancy, and it has since grown to have locations across Middle Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, John Brown had been a member of Calvary United Methodist Church since the early 1960s; a devoted man of God, he hosted a weekly men's prayer group consisting of some of his closest, dearest friends; and

WHEREAS, known for his deep love of Willie Nelson and Family, Judge Brown attended hundreds of their shows, often joining the band back stage, and eventually worked his way into Willie's show, joining the band to sing "harmony" with Willie at the end of the band's one instrumental song and performing countless times to his own adoring fans; he also fulfilled his lifelong ambition of singing on the stage of the Grand Ole Opry, in addition to many other venues; and

WHEREAS, his passions also included traveling throughout the country and the world with his wife, coaching youth football and baseball, and spending time with his family; and

WHEREAS, John Brown is survived by his loving wife of forty years, Anne Drury Brown; daughter, Joan Brown (Matt) Smith; sons, John P. "Jack" (Cindy) Brown III, Kevin Drury, and Matt Drury; grandchildren, Leah Hazel Bayston, Thaddeus Scott (Rachel) Bayston, Audrey Ruth

Bayston, Matthew Masin Drury, Jackson Porter Brown, and Isaac Drake Brown; and brothers, Robert (Susan) Brown and Phillip Brown; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his brother, Tom Brown; and

WHEREAS, Judge Brown leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional jurist, public servant, and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Judge John P. Brown, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Judge Brown.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.